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INDIA PICTURE

# Full Steam Ahead

**A veteran trainspotter remembers some of his favourite railway trips**

## Darjeeling Himalayan Railway

I loved the journey on the Darjeeling Himalayan Railway during my school days. The train passes through beautiful forested country, moving on from the plains in the early stages from Siliguri station to the very top to Ghum, the highest railway station in India, from where you can get views of Mt Khangchendzonga.



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## Kalka-Shimla Railway

After an overnight journey from Delhi on the Howrah-Kalka Express, one can connect with the Kalka-Shimla Railway. It was a train that carried the civil servants and the Viceroy and his entourage when the Raj moved from Calcutta to the summer capital of Shimla every year. The last stage of the journey was absolutely beautiful as the train moved through the foothills of the Himalayas to Shimla on a 2.6-ft track.

## Kangra Valley Railway

*The narrow-gauge Kangra Valley Railway runs from Pathankot. It used to be so crowded that once when I travelled on it with a friend of mine who was six feet tall, he couldn't put up with it because he was feeling so squashed. He just wanted to get off. But what is wonderful is that you run alongside those beautiful views of the snow-capped mountains and possibly some of the best views from an Indian train.*



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